Sādhana of Great Compassion with the Excellent Vase

Toh 2810 · Derge Tengyur
ཐུགས་རྗེ་ཆེ་པ་བུམ་པ་བཟང་པ་ཅོན་གྱི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

This short ritual manual, which may be called The Practice of Great Compassion with the Excellent Vase, is known in Tibetan by its opening homage, Thugs rje chen po bum pa bzang po can, and its Sanskrit title is not clearly attested. It is a practice text devoted to Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of great compassion, in a form associated with a golden treasure vase likened to a wish-fulfilling tree whose branches answer the hopes of beings. The work is addressed to faithful and intelligent practitioners who have fallen into poverty, and it describes how they may seek wealth together with spiritual accomplishment. It gives instructions for building a meditation hut on a site shaped like a vase, drawing and consecrating a vase on the practitioner's seat, and beginning a month of celibate devotion at the full moon. It is Toh 2810 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the tantric ritual and meditation manuals, or sādhanas, connected with Avalokiteśvara.

Homage to Great Compassion, the one with the excellent vase!

The great treasure, the supreme golden vase,
like a wish-fulfilling tree,
spreads its branches to answer beings' hopes.
I bow to the glorious one who dwells at its center.

Whatever practitioners of great intelligence,
though endowed with faith, have fallen into poverty,
should practice the Noble One
for wealth together with accomplishment.

First, at an excellent site, or on a base shaped like an excellent vase, build a meditation hut that resembles it. On the seat where one enters, draw a vase with perfect characteristics, and perform the auspicious rite of consecration. Then, when the moon has become full, call upon Avalokiteśvara to give heed, and for one month, by keeping celibacy, one should please the venerable one of great austerity. Afterward, when the day of the full moon comes again, put on fine clothes, trim the hair and beard, adorn yourself with many ornaments, and play much music. Perform prostrations, circumambulations and so forth before the image of the Noble One. Visualize hrīḥ at the heart, and with its

light dissolve the Noble Avalokiteśvara into the vase.

In the supreme celestial palace, a precious and excellent vase, richly curved,
its neck bound with divine cloth, adorned with wish-fulfilling branches and fruit;
at its center, on the tip of a stem, an udumbara flower,
upon which meditate on the Protector of the Three Worlds, red and beautiful, with a stream of wealth.

From the countless leaves and flowers there spring lotuses,
and on the tips of their anthers the Victor's heirs teach many Dharmas,
while hosts of playful offering goddesses radiate forth
and work miraculous displays all at once throughout this entire earth.

With darting glances, one foot raised,
hand resting on the hip, a smiling radiance, graceful poise and the like,
instruct even the fair-faced daughters of men,
and with excellent sons placed in front, strive to worship the Noble One.

oṃ āḥ hrīḥ sarvabuddhanimariddhiratna dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru vajrajñānakāruṇaye ratnaghaṭabhadra saṃpūrba susaṃpūrṇa kuru svāhā

Holding a fragrant protection cord in hand,
the head bound with a garland of flowers,
the one endowed with yoga recites the mantra
and receives accomplishment from the excellent vase.

In every fortnight, both the bright half and the dark,
one should satisfy the poor,
honor the guru with the first of what one gains,
and, attached to nothing, make offerings and give gifts.

The means of accomplishment of the One with the Excellent Vase is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The rare verb rendered "spreads" in the first verse appears to be a variant spelling for "spreading wide." "Every fortnight, both the bright half and the dark" interprets the terse line "white and black, half and half, in all directions" as referring to the waxing and waning halves of the month. The Tibetan word rendered "fortnight" ordinarily means "direction" or "side," but it also stands for the Sanskrit term for a half-month. "The venerable one of great austerity" is ambiguous in the Tibetan. It may refer to the deity being pleased or to the practitioner. The line about the "fair-faced daughters of men" and the "excellent sons placed in front" is obscure. It seems to describe young women, with dancing gestures, and boys being instructed to take part in the worship. The translation follows the Tibetan closely here. "Great Compassion"

(Mahākāruṇika) and "Protector of the Three Worlds" are epithets of Avalokiteśvara and are translated as epithets.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.